

Goal 3: IT Support, Certifications, and PR

A job-first plan for moving from material handling into genuine skilled technical support

Profile used: Age 23 | Single | No foreign experience | Two-year Canadian Computer Programming diploma | PGWP to 20 Jan 2029

Primary outcome: secure genuine TEER 2 IT support work, document it accurately, and use English, French, education, and Canadian skilled experience to build a realistic PR pathway.

A job title does not decide immigration eligibility. Actual duties, employer documentation, paid authorized work, hours, location, and the requirements of the specific program decide it.

1. Your approximate CRS starting point

Using your age 23, no spouse, two-year Canadian diploma, no foreign skilled work, no French result, and no qualifying skilled Canadian work, your approximate CRS is about 310 with CELPIP 8/7/7/7. This assumes no sibling in Canada, no second credential, and no additional factors.

Scenario	Approximate CRS
Current English 8/7/7/7; no French; no skilled Canadian work	310
CLB 9 in all English abilities	372
CLB 10 in all English abilities	384
CLB 9 English plus NCLC 7 French	434
CLB 10 English plus NCLC 7 French	446
CLB 9 + NCLC 7 French + one year skilled Canadian work	Approximately 487
CLB 10 + NCLC 7 French + one year skilled Canadian work	Approximately 499

These are planning estimates, not an invitation prediction. Current CRS rules no longer award Express Entry points for a job offer, although a job offer can still matter for eligibility in some programs.

2. NOC and role strategy

Role	NOC/TEER	What must be true	Priority
Help desk technician, service desk analyst, user support technician	22221 / TEER 2	First-line hardware/software troubleshooting, diagnosis, user support, ticket documentation	Highest
Computer help desk representative, systems support representative	22221 / TEER 2	Technical problem-solving and business-system/network support, not only account service	Highest
Technical support analyst/representative; hardware/software support	22221 / TEER 2	Reproduce, diagnose, resolve, document technical problems	High
Computer network technician or network support analyst	22220 / TEER 2	LAN/WAN maintenance, connectivity, installation, backup/security support	Medium
Information systems testing technician	22222 / TEER 2	Execute test plans, scripts, and application/system evaluation	Adjacent
Information systems specialist or technical support engineer	21222 / TEER 1	Systems analysis, requirements, implementation, and advice	Later
Technical support supervisor	22221 / TEER 2	Actually supervise technical support workers; experience normally expected	Future
Customer service technical representative	64409 / TEER 4 if mostly accounts/billing	General enquiries, orders, accounts, complaints, payments	Use caution
Current material handler	75101 / TEER 5	Move, load, unload, and handle materials	Income bridge, not CEC skilled work

NOC 22221 is officially TEER 2 and commonly requires a college program in computer science, computer programming, or network administration. Your diploma aligns with that typical education requirement. NOC 64409 is TEER 4, and NOC 75101 material handlers are TEER 5.

3. Certifications: the correct order

Certification priority

Order	Credential or training	Why it belongs here	Timing
1	Free foundations: Microsoft Learn, Cisco Networking Academy, Professor Messer	Build Windows, Linux, networking, troubleshooting, and PowerShell basics without spending money	Start now
2	Google IT Support Certificate, only if inexpensive or financial aid is available	Structured beginner curriculum; useful for discipline, but not a substitute for hands-on evidence	Months 1-2
3	CompTIA A+ (Core 1 and Core 2)	Most directly aligned with entry-level hardware/help-desk roles; buy vouchers only after strong practice scores	Study months 2-5
4	Microsoft Learn and optional SC-900	Useful Microsoft 365, Entra ID, identity, and security foundation if target postings request it	Months 5-7
5	CompTIA Network+	Useful for network-support roles after A+ and troubleshooting basics	After A+ or first job
6	CompTIA Security+	Useful for a deliberate security path, not required for first-line help desk	Later
7	ITIL Foundation	Take only if several target employers explicitly request it	Only when justified

Do not do this

- Do not buy A+, Network+, Security+, ITIL, and multiple bootcamps at once.
- Do not pay for an A+ exam voucher until practice scores are consistently strong and your budget can absorb a retake.
- Do not claim that a course is work experience or that a home lab is a production job.
- Do not misrepresent a job title or ask an employer to invent duties.

4. Home lab and portfolio

Project	Build	Evidence to publish
1. Help-desk environment	Windows and Ubuntu VMs, Windows Server evaluation if available, Active Directory users/groups, password reset, onboarding/offboarding, ticketing with osTicket	Architecture diagram, screenshots, sample tickets, knowledge-base articles, troubleshooting decision tree
2. Network troubleshooting	Packet Tracer LAN with IP addressing, DHCP, DNS, VLANs, Wireshark capture, simulated outage	Ticket, symptoms, isolation steps, root cause, fix, verification, escalation notes
3. PowerShell support automation	Inventory script, local-user and installed-software report, disk/service checks, event-log collection, safe support report	Code, test cases, output samples, security notes, limitations, no secrets

Every GitHub project should contain a README, objective, user problem, architecture, prerequisites, setup steps, screenshots with secrets removed, sample tickets, tests, security considerations, limitations, lessons learned, and future improvements.

5. Resume, LinkedIn, and interviews

- Resume headline: Computer Programming diploma graduate transitioning into IT support, with hands-on Windows, Linux, networking, PowerShell, ticketing, and troubleshooting labs.
- Use truthful GEODIS evidence: reliability on overnight shifts, safety, high-volume accuracy, learning scanners or warehouse systems, prioritization, and teamwork.

- Omit the 2.5 GPA unless specifically requested. Put projects above unrelated detail once they are working and documented.
- LinkedIn headline: Computer Programming Diploma | IT Support / Help Desk | Windows, Networking, PowerShell Home Lab.
- Prepare STAR stories about solving a process problem, learning quickly, preventing a safety issue, handling a difficult interaction, prioritizing under pressure, and recovering from a failed lab fix.
- Use the troubleshooting sequence: clarify, reproduce, isolate, fix, verify with the user, document, and escalate with evidence.

6. Job-search operating system

Period	Applications	Networking	Other
Months 1-2	5-8 targeted/week	3 conversations/month	Ask GEODIS about WMS, application-support, and IT openings
Months 3-7	10-15 targeted/week	3 conversations/week; 5 recruiter contacts/week	2 mock interviews/month; improve resume from response data
Peak-shift weeks	5-8 quality applications/week	One or two short contacts	Protect sleep; use Friday/Saturday deep work

Search terms: help desk technician, service desk analyst, IT support technician, desktop support, user support technician, technical support analyst, technical support representative, computer technician, application support, field service technician, WMS support, network support technician, and junior systems support.

7. Offer and NOC verification checklist

- 1 Get the written job description, legal employer name, work location, wage, hours, start date, and permanent or temporary status.
- 2 Compare the lead statement and most main duties with the official NOC page.
- 3 Confirm that the role is genuinely technical, not mostly billing, account updates, or general customer service.
- 4 Ask whether the employer will provide a reference letter listing title, dates, wage, hours, and actual duties.
- 5 Keep contracts, schedules, paystubs, tax documents, and supervisor contact details.
- 6 Only use a NOC that honestly matches what you performed.

8. PR timeline and pathway

- Primary federal plan: Canadian Experience Class after 1,560 hours of paid, authorized TEER 0-3 Canadian work, normally one year at 30 hours per week.
- For a genuine TEER 2 IT role, the CEC minimum language level is CLB 5 in all four English abilities or NCLC 5 in all four French abilities. Higher English and French scores improve CRS.
- French-language Express Entry requires NCLC 7 in all four French abilities and eligibility for an Express Entry program; ranking still controls invitations.
- Ontario changed its program in 2026. Previous streams were closed and a new Workforce Priority structure was introduced. Check the current official page before relying on Ontario.
- Atlantic or community pilots may be relevant after you have a designated-employer offer and meet the particular work, language, education, and settlement rules.

- Moving provinces alone does not create eligibility. Move only after verifying a live program, an eligible job, and your genuine intention to settle there.

If you start a qualifying IT job by March-June 2027, you could potentially complete one year of skilled Canadian work by March-June 2028, leaving useful time before your PGWP expiry on 20 January 2029.

9. Seven-month IT milestones

Month	Milestone
1	Free fundamentals, resume/LinkedIn, GitHub, lab setup, GEODIS internal inquiry
2	Project 1 working, 5-8 applications/week, finish or progress Google IT Support
3	Project 1 documented, Project 2 started, A+ preparation, first mock interview
4	Project 2 complete, apply broadly to NOC 22221 roles, attempt A+ Core 1 only if ready
5	Project 3, 12-15 applications/week, interview practice, optional Microsoft fundamentals
6	All projects polished, CRS estimate updated, 2 mock interviews, wider geographic search
7	Written-offer target, evidence system ready, decide whether to take A+ Core 2 or defer for budget

10. Minimum viable IT day

- Watch or read one 15-minute fundamentals lesson.
- Make one GitHub commit or write one troubleshooting note.
- Send one targeted application or networking message.
- Review one English technical explanation aloud.

Sources and verification links

NOC 22221, User support technicians | <https://noc.esdc.gc.ca/Structure/NOCProfile?code=22221&version=2021.0>

NOC 22220, Computer network and web technicians | <https://noc.esdc.gc.ca/Structure/NOCProfile?code=22220&version=2021.0>

NOC 22222, Information systems testing technicians | <https://noc.esdc.gc.ca/Structure/NOCProfile?code=22222&version=2021.0>

NOC 64409, Other customer and information services representatives | <https://noc.esdc.gc.ca/Structure/NOCProfile?code=64409&version=2021.0>

NOC 75101, Material handlers | <https://noc.esdc.gc.ca/Structure/NOCProfile?code=75101&version=2021.0>

IRCC, Canadian Experience Class |

<https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/who-can-apply/canadian-experience-class.html>

IRCC, CRS criteria | <https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/check-score/crs-criteria.html>

Ontario OINP 2026 program update | <https://www.ontario.ca/page/2026-ontario-immigrant-nominee-program-updates>

Microsoft Learn | <https://learn.microsoft.com/training/>

CompTIA A+ | <https://www.comptia.org/certifications/a>